

Xiaoyu Tong

📍 China ✉️ xiaoyuisrain@outlook.com 🌐 xiaoyuisrain.github.io 🗣️ [xiaoyuisrain](#) 🔗 [xiaoyu-tong-7a280b1a9](#)

Education

PhD	University of Amsterdam , Natural Language Processing	Amsterdam, NL
	- Thesis: <i>Dissecting incongruity: Metaphor and humor understanding of large language models</i> - Supervisors: Dr Ekaterina Shutova, Dr Martha Lewis	Sept 2021 – July 2026
MSc	University of Amsterdam , Brain and Cognitive Sciences	Amsterdam, NL
	- Research thesis: <i>Metaphor paraphrasing and word-sense disambiguation: toward a new approach to automated metaphor processing</i> - Literature thesis: <i>The potentiality of computational metaphor identification systems for studying human metaphor processing</i>	Sept 2018 – Mar 2021
MA	Xiamen University , Linguistics	Xiamen, China
		Sept 2014 – July 2017
	Xiamen University , Chinese Linguistics	Xiamen, China
		2012 – 2014
BA	Xiamen University , English Language and Literature	Xiamen, China
		2010 – 2014

Experience

Institute for Logic, Language and Computation, University of Amsterdam , Guest Researcher	Amsterdam, NL
Investigate cultural alignment of large language models.	2026 – present 1 year
Faculty of Science, University of Amsterdam , PhD Researcher	Amsterdam, NL
Studied the capabilities of large language models to process metaphor and humor.	2021 – 2026 5 years
- Created datasets containing 10k manual annotations. - Designed evaluation frameworks for monomodal and multimodal large language models. - Probed and fine-tuned large language models. - Analysed human data and model outputs using quantitative and qualitative methods.	
Institute for Logic, Language and Computation, University of Amsterdam , Research Intern	Amsterdam, NL
	2020 – 2021 1 year

Publications

Dissecting incongruity: Metaphor and humor understanding of large language models

Xiaoyu Tong

hdl.handle.net/11245.1/0bfb1d70-c5e8-4538-a554-d4c0e2ec0980

Hummus: A Dataset of Humorous Multimodal Metaphor Use

Xiaoyu Tong, Zhi Zhang, Pia Sommerauer, Martha Lewis, Ekaterina Shutova

arxiv.org/abs/2504.02983

A framework for annotating and modelling intentions behind metaphor use

Gianluca Michelli, Xiaoyu Tong, Ekaterina Shutova

aclanthology.org/2026.starsem-conference.4

Metaphor Understanding Challenge Dataset for LLMs

Xiaoyu Tong, Rochelle Choenni, Martha Lewis, Ekaterina Shutova

aclanthology.org/2024.acl-long.193

Beyond the Imitation Game: Quantifying and extrapolating the capabilities of language models

Aarohi Srivastava, et al.

arxiv.org/abs/2206.04615

Recent advances in neural metaphor processing: A linguistic, cognitive and social perspective

Xiaoyu Tong, Ekaterina Shutova, Martha Lewis

aclanthology.org/2021.naacl-main.372

Skills

Programming

Formatting & Graphic Design

Languages

Mandarin Chinese

Native

English

Fluent

Japanese

Conversational

Interests

Artificial Intelligence

Linguistics

Cognitive Science